BALAJI KARUNAKARAN

SUBJECT MATTER EXPERT | US PAYROLL

(+91) 9790647688
balajikarunakaran1999@gmail.com
1A, Mahali Amman Kovil Street,
Veerakeralam, Coimbatore - 641 007
Tamil Nadu, India

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Subject Matter Expert with 4.11 years of experience in US payroll processing. Experienced in payroll operations, pre- and post-payroll validation, garnishments, payroll adjustments, tax/rate updates, off-cycle and bonus payrolls, 401(k) deductions, payroll audits, reconciliation, client communication, and discrepancy resolution. Hands-on experience with Paychex and strong understanding of the end-to-end US payroll lifecycle, with a focus on accuracy, compliance, SLA adherence, and process improvement.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

COGNIZANT TECHNOLOGY SOLUTIONS | **Subject Matter Expert**

2021 – Present

- Manage US payroll processing across multiple pay frequencies and validate payroll inputs before processing.
- Process employee setup, updates, terminations, earnings, deductions, adjustments, voids, reversals, and reissues in line with payroll requirements
- Administer garnishments including child support, bankruptcy, and state tax levies based on applicable orders and payroll instructions.
- Review and support payroll tax reporting by providing system-generated Forms 941, 940, and state reports to clients and downstream teams; support tax/rate updates based on client-provided notices.
- Process off-cycle and bonus payrolls and validate gross-to-net and net-to-gross calculations.
- Review 401(k) deductions and flag contribution limits or deduction variances for client/team action.
- Processed 2% shareholder wages/deductions and maintain third-party disability pay for YTD reporting.
- Perform pre- and post-payroll audits, variance checks, reconciliations, and root-cause analysis to identify and correct discrepancies.
- Resolved employee and client payroll inquiries through ticketing/internal tools and communicate clear resolutions within SLA.
- Train and onboard new payroll team members, support SOP maintenance, and contribute to process improvements.

CORE SKILLS

- US Payroll Processing
- Payroll Validation & Audits
- Garnishments & Deductions
- 401(k) & Benefits Deductions
- Payroll Adjustments, Voids & Reissues
- RCA / Issue Resolution
- Client & Employee Support
- Team Training & SOP Support

KEY SKILLS

- MS Excel • VLOOKUP • Pivot Tables
- Payroll Import
- Data Validation
- Import File Validation
- SLA Management

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Supported timely and accurate processing of payroll with strong SLA adherence.
- Improved payroll accuracy through structured validation and internal audit checks.
- Trained and mentored new hires to become productive payroll team members.
- Recognized for accuracy, compliance, ownership, and process improvement.

EDUCATION

SRMV College of Arts & Science — B.Com | 2017 – 2020

SRMV Swami Shivanandha Higher Secondary School — Higher Secondary | 2015 – 2017

Vidhya Vikas Matric Higher Secondary School — Secondary | 2015

LANGUAGES

Tamil • English

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Primary Payroll Platform: **Finesse**
Primary Payroll Software: **Paychex**